

Case: engine loss after a fuel-tank switch (U.S. aviation safety investigation, 28 evidence items). The engine ran smoothly until the pilot selected the left tank, then lost power; he landed in the water (E3.4–E3.6). Preflight draining showed no water (E3.1). An added “FERRY TANK” valve in the left fuel line was found ON, with no guard or safety wire (E4.8–E4.10); the left tank connected to the engine only with that valve OFF (E4.9).

Official finding: inadvertent activation of the unguarded ferry-tank valve caused fuel starvation — the case should be closed.

✓ **Reads the valve test, closes**

Gemini 3.8 Flash

The total loss of engine power was caused by fuel starvation ... due to an unapproved, unguarded ferry-tank selector valve that had been left in the "ON" position ...

Continuity from the left tank to the engine was only established when the ferry-tank valve was moved to "OFF" [E4.9]. ...

CASE CLOSED

✗ **Misreads the test, stays open**

Nautil-SFT (9B)

CASE NOT CLOSED. ... the pilot reported no visible water in either tank at preflight draining ... continuity through the ferry-tank selector was absent in both observed positions (E4.9). ...

What is not established: whether the left tank contained fuel contaminated with water ... Whether the undocumented ferry-tank arrangement caused the interruption is likewise unproven.

✗ **Reads the test, still stays open**

Nautil-RLVR (9B)

CASE NOT CLOSED – the target cause, a fuel-path interruption ..., is supported but not conclusively identified. ...

no continuity could be established from the left selector position to the engine except when the ferry-tank selector was OFF (E4.4, E4.7, E4.9). ... Its role in the interruption is plausible but unproven by this evidence.